



# **INTRODUCTION TO INDIAN PSYCHOLOGY**

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## **CONCEPT OF MANAS IN AYURVEDA AND UNDERSTANDING MIND BODY HARMONY**

- ▶ In ayurveda, Manas , or the ‘mind’ , is a central concept that signifies more than just cognitive functions. It is the bridge between body, emotions, and consciousness.

### Qualities of Manas

- 1) Sattva ( balance , harmony, purity ) : sattva is the state of mental clarity, positivity , and awareness.
- 2) Rajas ( activity , passion ) : represents dynamism and energy but can lead to restlessness and stress if not balanced.
- 3) Tamas ( inertia, darkness ) : leads to dullness, lethargy etc.

## **THE MIND – BODY CONNECTION**

Ayurveda views the mind and body as interconnected parts of a whole. Imbalances in one can affect the other.

1. Emotional stress & physical health
2. Physical illness & mental state

### Practices in Mind – body harmony in Ayurveda

1. Diet & lifestyle changes
2. Yoga & pranayama
3. Meditation
4. Mindfulness
5. Herbal support such as Brahmi, Ashwagandha .

## **TRIGUNA BASED PSYCHOLOGY IN AYURVEDA AND YOGA**

- ▶ Triguna means three primary qualities of the mind – forms. These three qualities are seen as universal forces that influence mental states, emotions, and behaviours , and they shape one's overall personality and worldview.

The three qualities are :

- 1) Sattva (purity, harmony, lightness) : represents a state of mental clarity, harmony, wisdom, and balance. A sattvic person exhibits traits like kindness, honesty , patience etc.
- 2) Rajas (activity, passion, dynamism) : represents energy, movement and action. A rajasic person may be driven, ambitious, enthusiastic, and creative.
- 3) Tamas (inertia , darkness, lethargy) : quality of dullness, inertia, and ignorance. A tamasic mind is prone to negative emotions, and possibly depressions.

Triguna – based personality types in ayurvedic psychology

1. Sattvic personality – individuals with a sattvic personality are compassionate , self aware and serene.
2. Rajasic personality – individuals are energetic, driven & often competitive.
3. Tamasic personality – people with tamasic nature may appear passive, inert, and are typically resistant to change.

## **INFLUENCE OF TRIDOSHA ON MIND**

In ayurveda, the concept of Tridosha : Vata, Pitta & Kapha.

- ▶ In the mind, **vata** influences our thinking patterns , imagination patterns , imagination and adaptability.
- ▶ Imbalance in vata can lead to mental instability, anxiety, nervousness etc.
- ▶ Balancing vata such as practicing gentle yoga, meditation. Eating warm & nourishing foods.
- ▶ When vata is balanced, it creates focus, confidence , determination.
- ▶ Excessive **pitta** in mind can lead to aggression, irritability, anger, impatience.
- ▶ Calming practices such as spending time in nature, practicing cooling breath techniques , consuming cooling foods helps to reduce pitta.
- ▶ A balanced kapha exhibits calmness, patience, loyalty .
- ▶ When **kapha** is excessive , it can lead to mental lethargy, attachment, depression.
- ▶ Dynamic yoga, regular physical exercises , and an active lifestyle helps balance kapha.

## **MIND BODY INTELLECT AND CONSCIOUSNESS COMPLEX**

In Ayurveda, Yoga and Vedantic philosophy, the human being is viewed as a complex integration of Mind (Manas), Body (Sharira), Intellect (Buddhi) and Consciousness (Atman or Purusha).

### **1. Body (Sharira)**

It is the physical aspect of the self , made up of the 5 elements (earth, water, fire, air and ether) and governed by 3 doshas : vata, pitta & kapha.

Ayurveda emphasizes that a balanced and healthy body is foundational to a healthy mind and spirit. , as it provides the stability and energy needed for mental clarity and spiritual pursuits.

### **2. Mind ( Manas )**

Manas is the mental faculty that processes sensory information , emotions, thoughts and experiences. The mind is characterized by 3 gunas : Sattva, Rajas, Tamas.

### **3. Intellect (Buddhi)**

Buddhi refers to the higher intelligence or intellect, which governs reasoning , judgement, and decision making.

Buddhi acts as the guiding force for the mind , providing clarity, insight and purpose.

### **4. Consciousness (Atman or Purushas)**

In Vedanta & Yoga , Atman (in Vedanta) or Purusha refers to the pure , unchanging consciousness or the true self.

Spiritual practices like meditation, yoga is to help individuals transcend identification with the body, mind and intellect, allowing them to experience their true nature as consciousness itself.

## **UNDERSTANDING CONSCIOUSNESS AND SOLUTION TO ISSUES WITHIN HUMAN MIND**

- ▶ **Consciousness is the state of being aware of internal and external existence. It's the faculty of being conscious , and is a condition that accompanies all thought, feeling, and volition.**
- ▶ **Humans encounter a range of mental challenges that may affect consciousness and quality of life. Such as :**
  - 1) **Stress & anxiety**
  - 2) **Depression & negative thought patterns**
  - 3) **Addictive behaviour**
- ▶ **Improving consciousness and resolving mental issues often involve a combination of therapeutic and reflective practices that increase awareness, manage stress and encourage positive thought patterns.**
  - 1) **Meditation**
  - 2) **Yoga practice**
  - 3) **Physical activities**
  - 4) **Self reflection & journaling (writing down thoughts, dreams etc. )**
  - 5) **AI and machine learning : theses tools can analyse patterns of thought and behaviour, helping creating personalized therapies that address individual needs.**

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